Bloomberg

INTERACTION DESIGN EXERCISE

# Project Goals

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## Alerting

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# Bloomberg

UX – INTERACTION DESIGN EXERCISE FOR MANAGING ALERTS

## Context

A **"Monitor"** is an application on the Bloomberg Terminal that allows users to track the performance of any list of securities. The securities are laid out as rows and users pick which columns of data to see on each security. *See the image below.*

Each of these columns is known as a **"field"**. In this example, you can see "Curr Px" (current price), "% on day" (change in price since market open as %), and so on. **Tens of thousands** of these fields

are available to our users. More examples of fields include moving averages, various flavors of trading volume, high/low/open/close/bid/ask prices, etc.

The Monitor enables users to choose any securities and any fields they are interested in and display this information on their desktop consistently. To stay up to date, most Bloomberg customers use multiple computer displays and place multiple Monitors as well as other Bloomberg components on their desktop.

## Challenge

Traders are some of the most information-hungry of financial users. They track hundreds or thousands of securities at a time and so need help to draw their attention to securities when certain data events happen. Bloomberg call this concept **"alerting"**. For this target audience, Bloomberg was seeking a design for creating such an alert, where the trader will specify the security, field, and other parameters as appropriate. The design should address the following use-cases (Bloomberg-provided fields are in bold:

1. Creating a "field-value" alert for a security: compares a given field to a constant value that the trader picks. E.g., Apple's **Last Price** exceeds 600 or IBM's **Last Price** moves by 10% in either direction.
2. Creating a "field-field" alert for a security: compares a given field to another field, e.g., S&P500's **Last Price** falls below S&P500's **52-week Low Price.**

## Idea

Below are actions in my R&D process that assisted me in understanding the features and functionality of the Bloomberg terminal. It was also important for me to get an idea of usability of the terminals as would be tutored to a new user.

- watched a few "**Introduction to Bloomberg Terminal**" YouTube videos
- search for screenshots of Bloomberg's terminal
- search for images of other financial data terminals

- research other alerting systems not directly related to financial data from companies like “eTrade, Google, MSN, Yahoo”.

The findings assisted in the documenting of the business requirements, and the creation of artifacts to assist in the design of the alerting experience.

## Solution

I created paper sketches of the customer journey (storyboard), user flow diagram and low-fidelity wireframe, based on the R&D findings, design exercise requirements, and goals of the user.

Axure was the tool of choice used in polishing the sketches, and creating a clickable high-fidelity prototype of the alerting system.

## Result

Inconclusive.